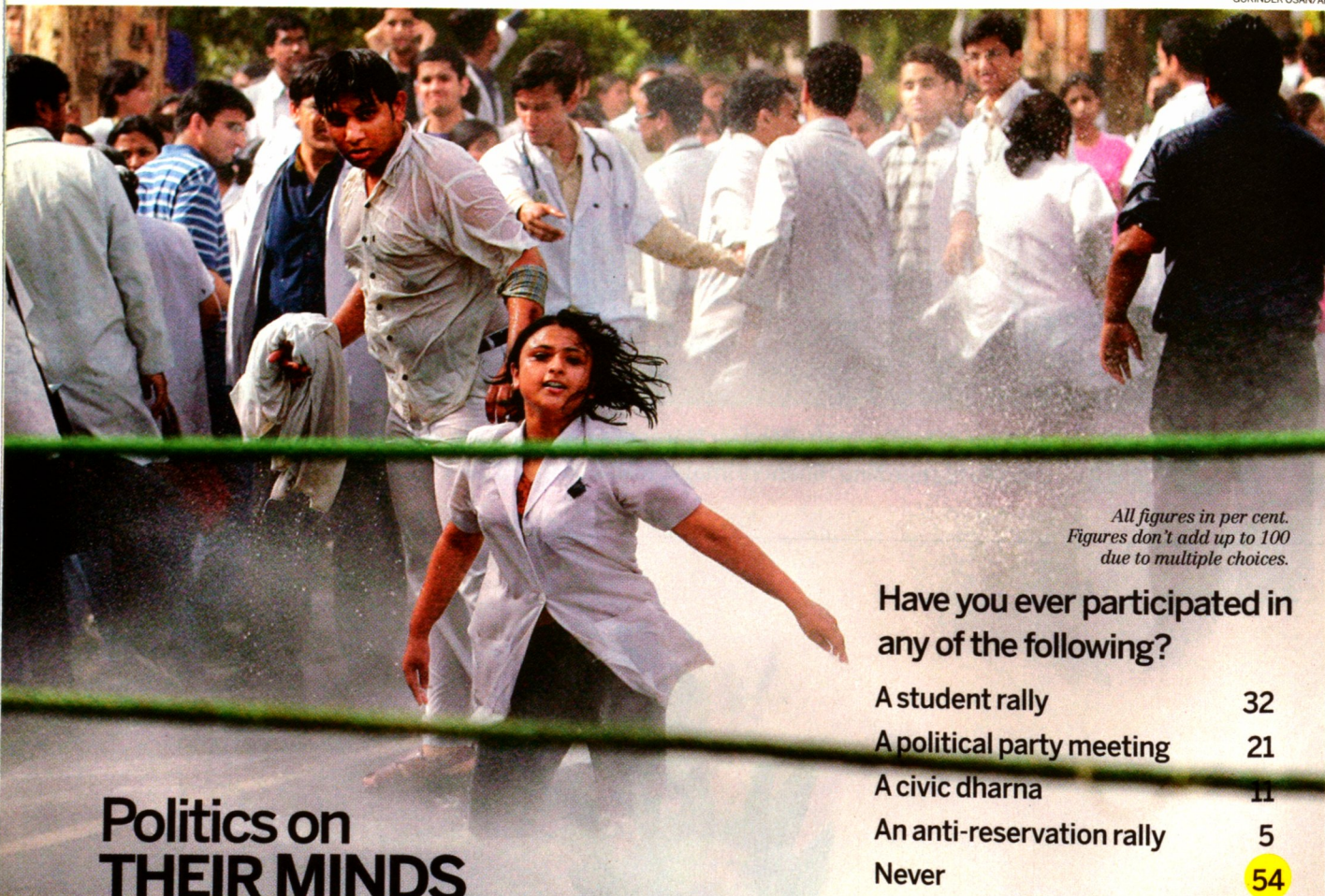


Synovate Youth and Politics Survey 2009. The profile that emerges out of the poll, conducted across eight cities, is of a young India with a political mind of its own. And remember: the young in India are a demographic force, for over half of our population is below 25 and two out of every three Indians are 35 or less (the number of Indians between 18 and 35 is 247 million, and it

is growing at the rate of 3.4 per cent every year). They are not anti-politics; they are just disillusioned with the kind of politician who dominates the arena: corrupt, doddering, and creatively dead. They are aware that they are a vital part of one of the world's most engrossing democracies, that their stakes as responsible citizens are higher. And a majority of them have stood in a

GURINDER OSAN/AP



*All figures in per cent.  
Figures don't add up to 100  
due to multiple choices.*

## Politics on THEIR MINDS

**Have you ever participated in any of the following?**

|                           |    |
|---------------------------|----|
| A student rally           | 32 |
| A political party meeting | 21 |
| A civic dharna            | 11 |
| An anti-reservation rally | 5  |
| Never                     | 54 |

And that's where it stays. Big talk is not backed by big action as young India shows little interest in any form of local political participation.

**In which elections have you voted?**

|                           |    |
|---------------------------|----|
| General Elections         | 65 |
| Assembly Elections        | 54 |
| Student Body Elections    | 21 |
| Any other election        | 15 |
| Not voted in any election | 20 |

*All figures in per cent. Figures don't add up to 100 due to multiple choices.*

**If not, why?**

|                                                |    |
|------------------------------------------------|----|
| Name was not on the voter's list               | 67 |
| I was too young                                | 21 |
| I was not enthused by the political candidates | 12 |
| Don't know/Can't say                           | 1  |

*All figures in per cent for the 320 respondents who have not voted in any election.*

Mumbai's youth are the most politically active. About 80 per cent of them have voted in general elections, the highest in the country, followed by 77 per cent in Kochi and 75 per cent in Delhi. In Chennai, about 31 per cent have not voted in any election.

**64%** say that they have never contested a student election in college or university nor would they like to in the future